

TRUSTMRR DATASET STUDY

Inside 1,000 Indie Startups

A data-driven look at revenue, growth, category mix, and marketplace dynamics across the TrustMRR startup dataset

1,000 startups

29 data fields

65 countries

Frozen 30 Jul 2026

What TrustMRR Tracks, and the Shape of the Sample

A wide, messy, real-world dataset — heavy skew and missing fields are part of the story, not noise to clean away

Each Record Captures

Revenue & MRR:

30-day, 3-month, 12-month, and all-time revenue, plus 30-day growth %

Traction:

Active subscriptions, X followers, domain rating, visitors

Positioning:

Category, audience type, pricing model, target persona

Marketplace status:

Whether listed for sale, asking price, revenue multiple

1,000

startups tracked

29

data fields per record

65

countries represented

29

startup categories

26.2%

listed for sale on the marketplace

19.7%

report exactly \$0 MRR

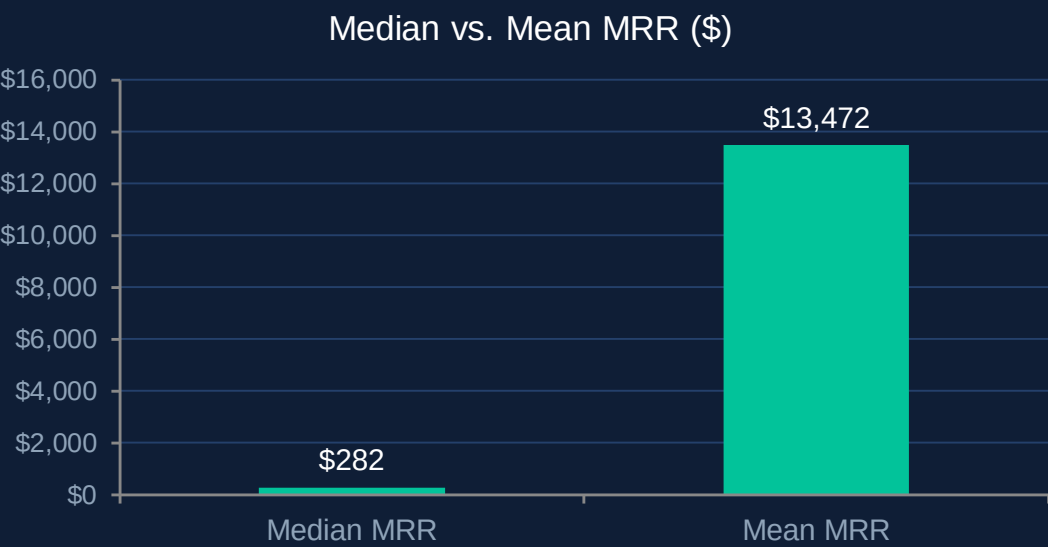
Data Quality Note

Optional profile fields are sparsely filled: 34% of records have no listed pricing model, 29% no category tag, and 86% no visitor-traffic data. Treat category- and persona-level data as directional, not exhaustive.

REVENUE DISTRIBUTION

A Few Giants, a Long Tail

MRR is heavily right-skewed — the mean is not a fair summary of a 'typical' startup



MRR by Percentile

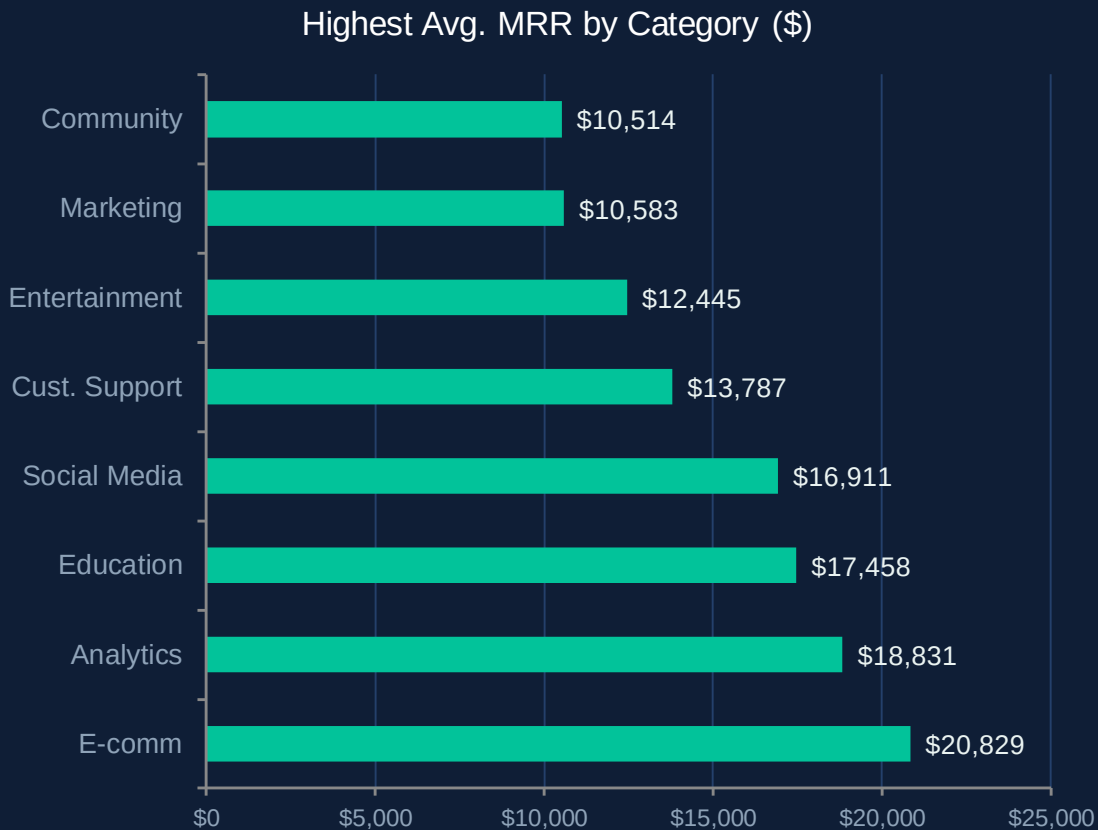
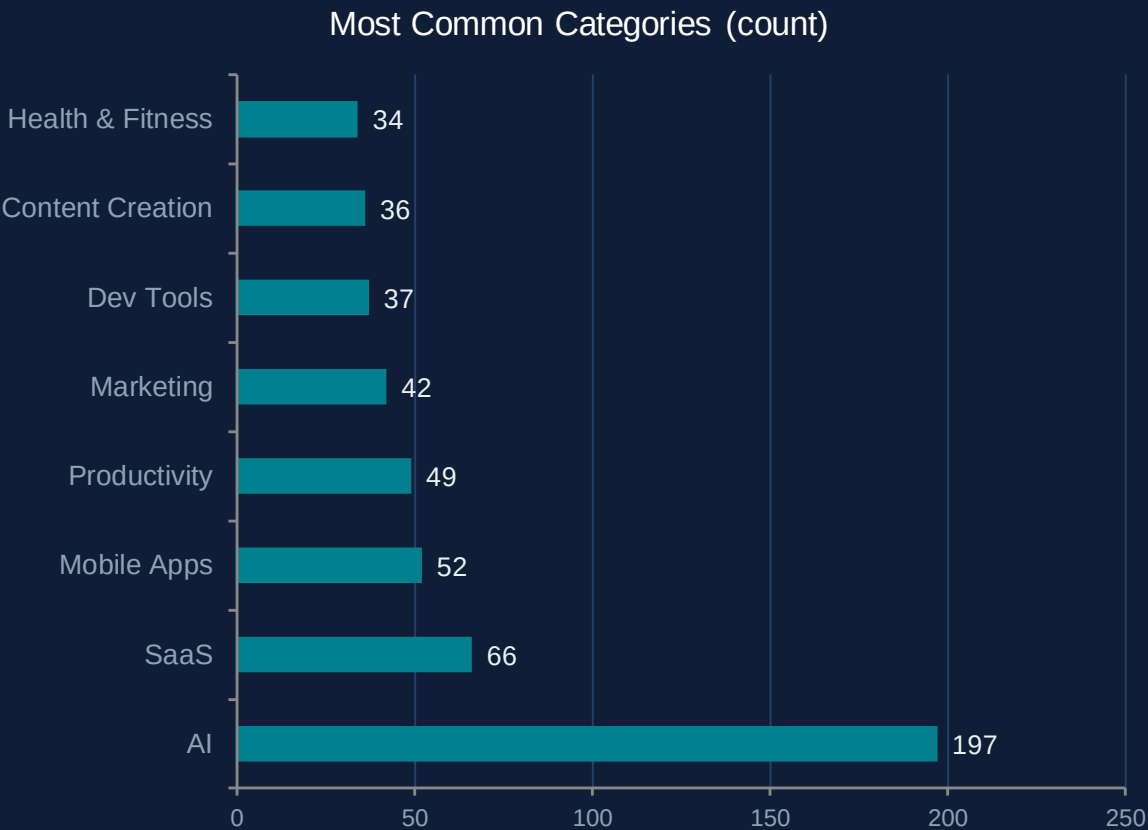
Percentile	MRR (\$)
P10	\$0
P25	\$10
P50 (median)	\$282
P75	\$5,040
P90	\$23,369
P99	\$177,206

Why It Matters

Mean MRR (\$13,472) is ~48x the median (\$282) — a handful of outliers (Stan, Brand On Demand, GojiberryAI) pull the average far above what a typical startup earns. The top 10 startups alone account for **~48% of all MRR** on the platform. Median active subscriptions is just 16, vs. a mean of 501 — the same skew shows up in traction, not just revenue.

Category Volume vs. Category Value

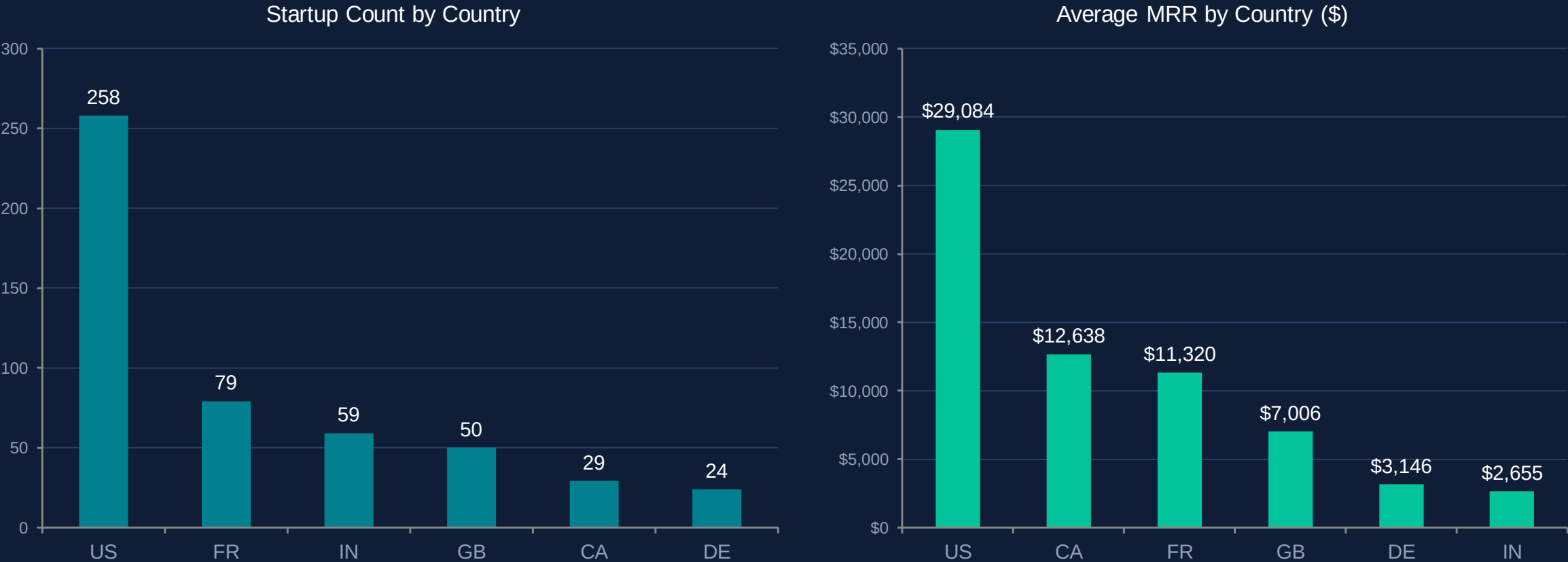
AI dominates by headcount — but it isn't the category that earns the most per company



AI ranks only 9th in average MRR (\$9,167) despite having 3x more startups than the next category — a crowded field competing on volume, not average revenue per company.

The US Leads on Both Volume and Value

Top countries by startup count, and how their average MRR compares

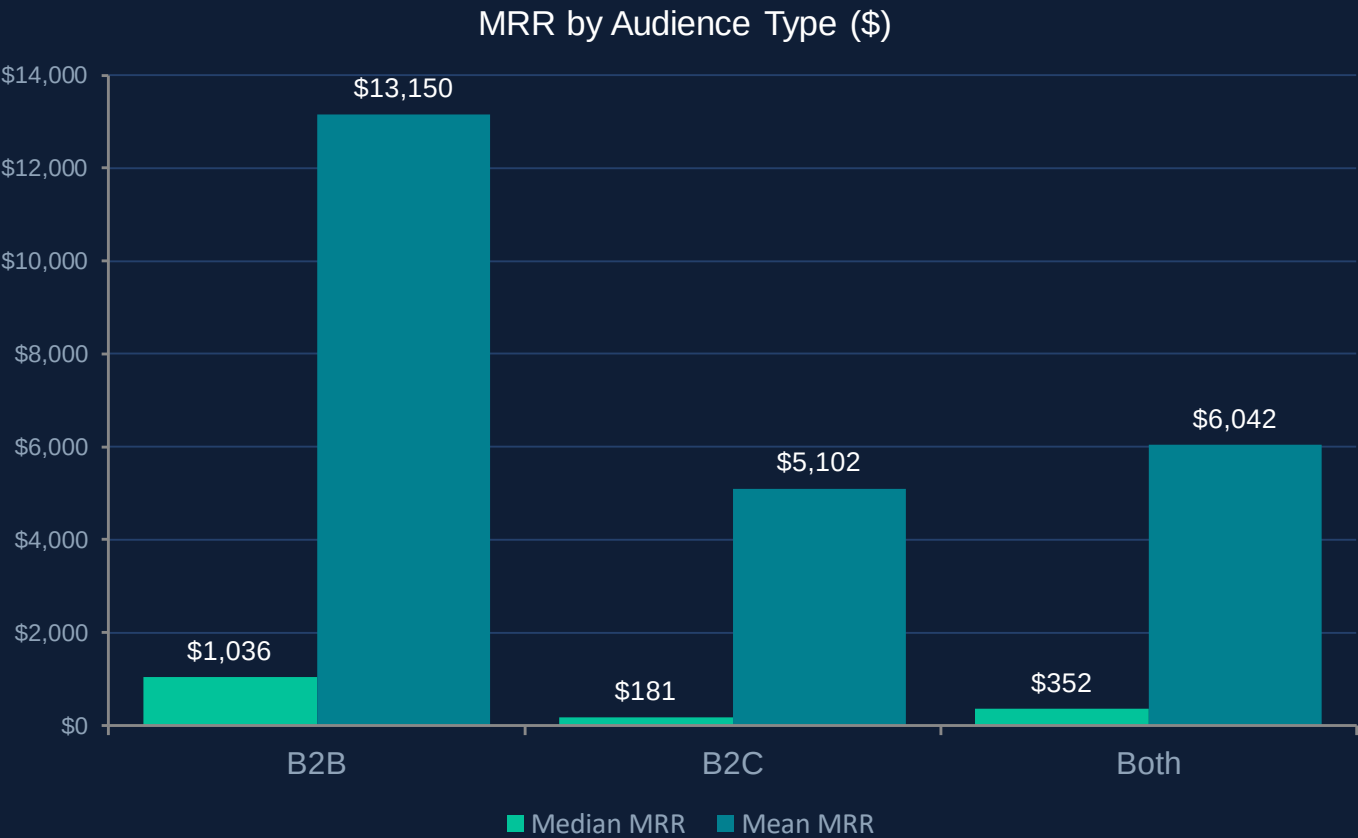


US startups average 11x India's average MRR despite India having the 3rd-highest startup count (59) — success is concentrated, not evenly spread across the 65 countries represented.

AUDIENCE TYPE

B2B Startups Out-Earn B2C

Median and average MRR by who the startup actually sells to



255

B2B startups — median MRR \$1,036

401

B2C startups — median MRR \$181

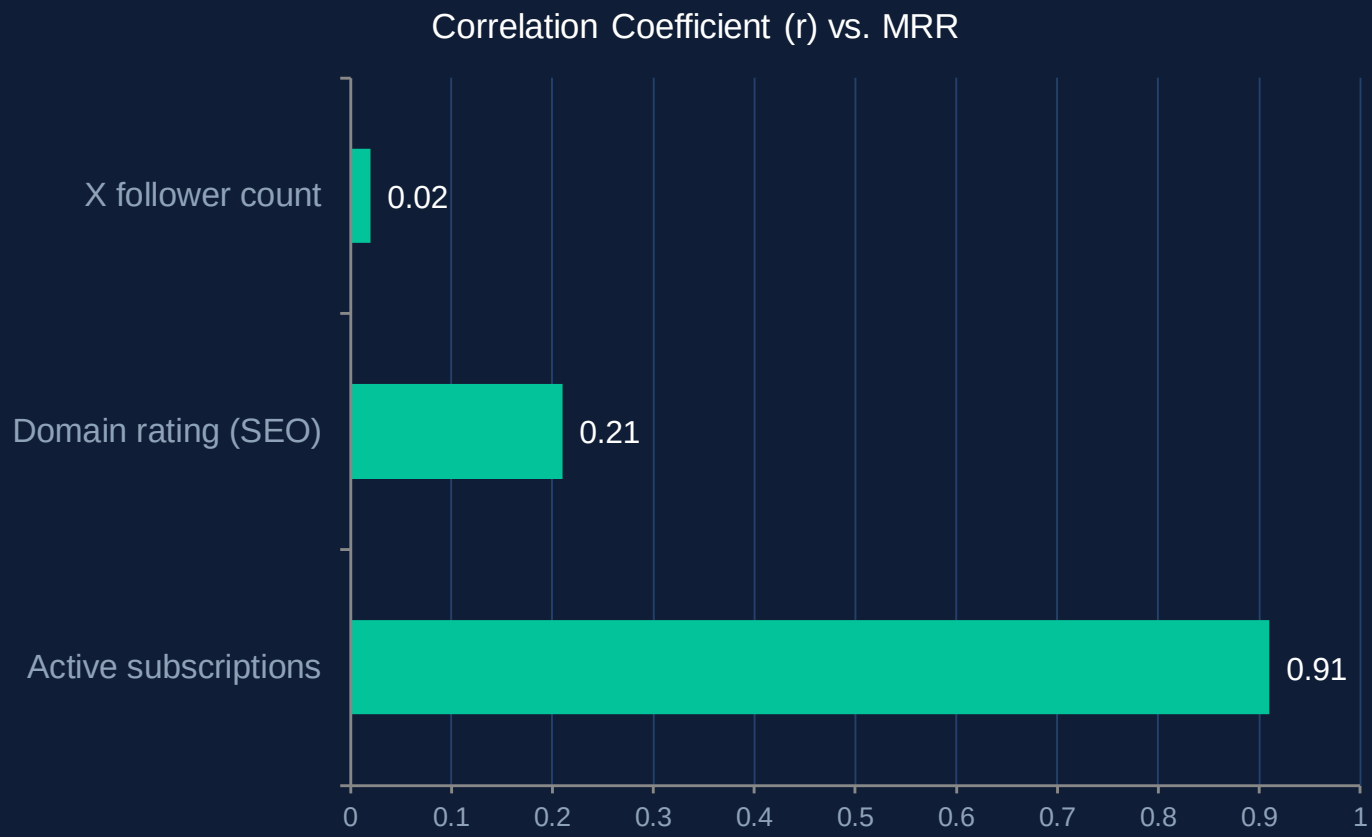
56

Serve both — median MRR \$352

Median B2B MRR is nearly 6x median B2C MRR — enterprise-style pricing outweighs consumer scale in this sample.

What Actually Predicts Revenue?

Correlation of MRR with three commonly-cited 'traction' signals



Reading the Signal

Active subscriptions (r = 0.91)

The strongest predictor by far — paying-user count tracks revenue almost mechanically, as expected.

Domain rating (r = 0.21)

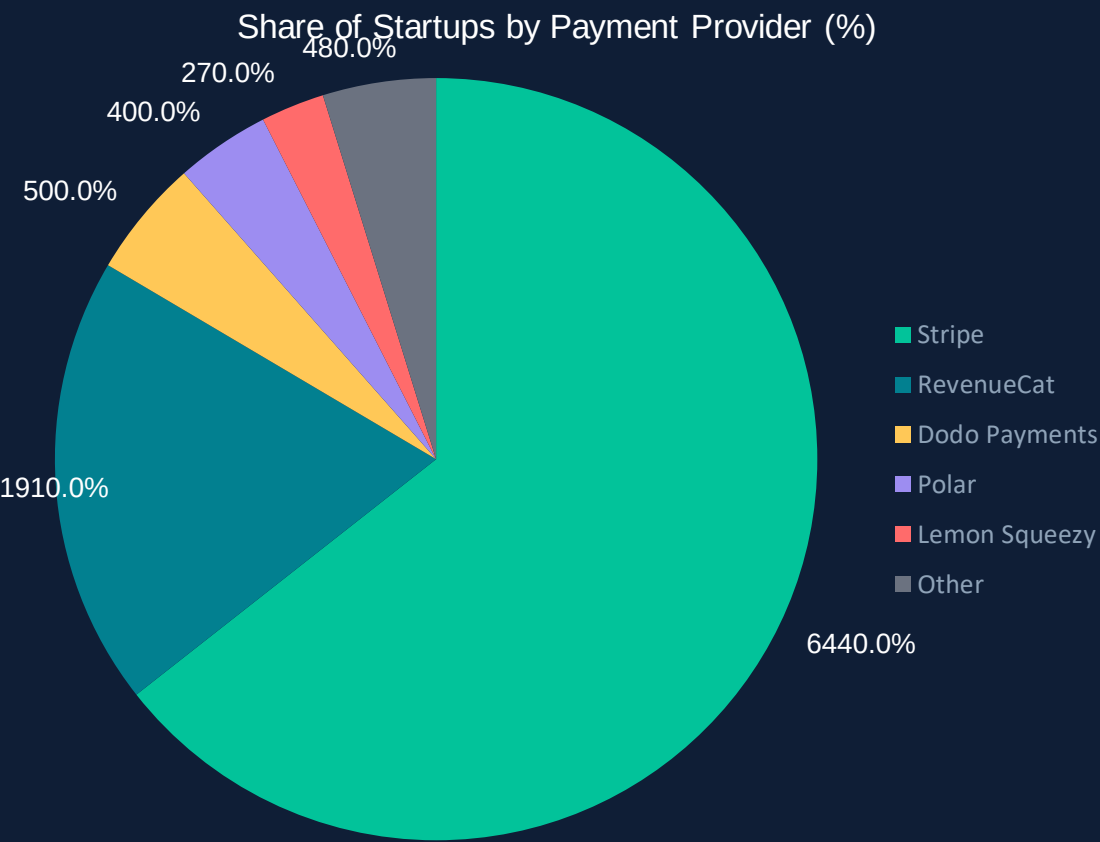
A weak positive link. SEO authority correlates loosely with revenue but explains only a small share of it.

X followers (r = 0.02)

Effectively no relationship. Social audience size is not a reliable stand-in for revenue.

Payment Rails: Who Indie Founders Use

Stripe dominates by adoption — but the highest-earning startups aren't always on the most popular rail



Median & Mean MRR by Provider

Provider	n	Median	Mean
Stripe	644	\$663	\$18,344
RevenueCat	191	\$237	\$6,006
Superwall	19	\$7,337	\$16,641
Lemon Squeezy	27	\$15	\$1,043
Dodo Payments	50	\$2	\$255
Polar	40	\$0	\$77

Superwall's small cohort (n=19) skews mobile-subscription apps and posts a median MRR (\$7,337) over 10x Stripe's — a reminder that provider choice often reflects business model, not causation.

This Month's Fastest Movers

Startups with MRR above \$1,000 that posted the largest 30-day MRR growth

Startup	Category	MRR (\$)	30-Day MRR Growth
Hidden Jobs	Recruiting & HR	\$1,076	+1,357%
HotelHero.ai	AI	\$1,460	+1,227%
Hong Xuan Kow	AI	\$20,254	+459%
Kickly – Pronos IA	Games	\$10,236	+385%
BillionVerify	Marketing	\$1,292	+294%
LLM Gateway	AI	\$47,172	+240%

AI shows up 3 of 6 times among growth leaders — even though it lags on average revenue per company, it's where the fastest month-over-month momentum is concentrated.

The Acquisition Marketplace

1 in 4 startups is listed for sale — and sellers skew mid-size, not top-of-market

262

startups on sale (26.2%)

\$35K

median asking price

2.3x

median revenue multiple

On Sale vs. Not for Sale (MRR)

	On Sale	Not for Sale
Median MRR	\$1,055	\$187
Mean MRR	\$7,809	\$15,482

Mean MRR is lower for on-sale startups than for the platform overall — the biggest whales (Stan, GojiberryAI) aren't listed.

Top Asking Prices

Startup	MRR	Asking Price
1Lookup	\$207,064	\$10.0M
Project A	\$61,543	\$5.0M
POST BRIDGE	\$41,777	\$4.2M

All three sit in the \$40K–\$210K MRR range — established, mid-market businesses rather than category giants.

SUMMARY

Key Takeaways

01

Skew, not scale

Median MRR (\$282) tells the real story of a typical startup — the top 10 alone hold ~48% of all platform MRR.

02

Volume ≠ value

AI has 3x more startups than any other category, but ranks only 9th in average MRR per company.

03

Subscriptions predict revenue — little else does

Active subscriptions correlate at $r=0.91$ with MRR; domain rating barely helps ($r=0.21$) and followers don't at all ($r=0.02$).

04

Geography compounds

The US leads on both count and average MRR (\$29K) — 11x India's average despite India's larger sample.

05

B2B pays more

Median B2B MRR (\$1,036) is nearly 6x median B2C MRR (\$181).

06

Rails reflect business model

Stripe dominates adoption (64%), but niche rails like Superwall post higher medians — a proxy for mobile-subscription models, not causation.

07

Momentum clusters in AI

3 of the 6 fastest-growing startups this month are in AI, even though the TrustMRR 1,000-Range category lags on average revenue.

08

Sellers are mid-market

Startups for sale skew toward established-but-not-massive MRR (median \$1,055) — the true top performers aren't listed.